

vate it and select the region of the image you wish to retain. Don't try too hard to align it perfectly, because you can easily move the selection area later on. Once a rectangle is formed on the image, the selected area will appear lighter, and bordered by a dashed line that



Using the Crop Tool

appears like it is moving. You will find tiny squares called selection handles, which can be used to change the area of selection. If you move the mouse out of the selection, you will see that the pointer changes to a two-sided arrow. You can now rotate the selection as desired. After rotating it to include the desired parts, you can fine-tune it by using the handles again. Once you are sure of the selection, just press Enter or use Image > Crop.

2.4 Adjusting Brightness And Contrast

If an image has been shot in low light, it can be made to look brighter by increasing the brightness level. Generally, when brightness is increased, the image appears to be low on contrast, that is, the colours don't appear vivid or distinct—there appears to be a whitish tinge. In such cases, the images can be made to look richer by increasing the contrast level. Contrast can be increased irrespective of the brightness levels, until the point where distortion starts to appear. This setting again is subjective, and just how much you increase contrast is your decision, based on trial and error. As a rule of thumb, keep the contrast within 5 units of the brightness. But if going beyond this range makes your image look better, just go ahead!